

Chapter-4

Discussion

This study is designed to understand and explore the social emotions of guilt, shame and remorse related to appraisal by investigating the following aims i.e. (1) explore the situations that generate the social emotions of guilt, shame and remorse, and (2) evaluate the emotional experiences of guilt, shame and remorse with reference to the levels of appraisal. Therefore with respect to the aims the noteworthy findings are presented and discussed in holistic manner by referring the existing literature.

4.1 Discussion

4.1.1 Aim 1

Predominant events associated with the social emotions of guilt, shame, and remorse was analyzed to identify the distinct situations representing the occurrence of these emotions in individuals' daily lives. This process involves utilizing qualitative analysis software, leveraging participants open-ended responses obtained from the Emotional Experience Questionnaire (EEQ).

By identifying the situations of guilt, shame and remorse separately and altogether our findings are in line with the research conducted by Bushan et al. (2020) and Tangney (1992) indicating that similar situations can elicit both shame and guilt. Moreover, the findings of Lewis (1971) and Taylor (1996) substantiate the notion that a singular event has the potential to invoke both guilt and remorse concurrently.

4.1.1.1 Situation 1. *Guilt and shame* related to the *internet* are induced from various sources. It may stem from excessive time spent online, sharing inappropriate content and engaging in harmful behavior. Russo et al. (2022) reported the positive correlation between interpersonal guilt and different types of problematic internet usage (PIU), namely online gaming, excess social media use, and pornography. Similarly, internet addiction, cyber bullying, sharing sensitive information, or violating social norms are also having strong correlation with shame and guilt and positively related to showing the effects on self-esteem and mental well-being among users (Teymouri-Farkush et al; 2022).

4.1.1.2 Situation 2. Further, broken *relationship* and trust induced the emotion of *shame* and *guilt*. It happens because of hurting someone they care about

and doing actions or words that breach trust, respect and mutual understanding. For instance, we feel guilty over neglecting our mother or when we intentionally or unintentionally hurt our social relationship. Sometimes it get verse and try to apologize them. Therefore, guilt is a negative emotional state associated with an internal experience of tension, remorse, and agitation elicited by breaching of moral values (Ferguson, Stegge, & Damhuis, 1991; Tangney, 1992). The study of Hargreaves (2002) reveals that after repeated experiences of betrayal the student tend to withdraw to their own classroom, stays away from difficult colleagues and avoid interaction with them and make distance them psychologically from what they are experiencing. Therefore, betrayal leads to negativity, isolation and conflict in social contacts. In this way, intense or repeated betrayals break the bonds of professional interaction and social relationship as well as social distortion among students.

4.1.1.3 Situation 3. For *prejudice* and *discrimination* the *shame* and *guilt* stems from treating others unfairly based on characteristics like race, gender, or background. It arises when one recognizes their actions perpetuate inequality or harm. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and responsibility to rectify the situation, promote equity, and challenge biases. Classic theorists of stigma and prejudice make the assertion under certain conditions; those who are socially stigmatized might come to feel a sense of shame for aspects of their stigmatized identity. Gordon Allport (1954) suggests that if victim of prejudice come to identify with the dominant group, they will develop a sense of self-hate. For example, “the immigrant grows ashamed of his faulty accent, his lack of ease and social grace, his defective education”. Further, people are thought to feel ashamed when they attribute a negative event to an uncontrollable and internal aspect of themselves (Weiner, 1995; Wicker et al., 1983). Therefore, shame related to prejudice is often characterized by feelings of self-consciousness and a fear of rejection (Lewis, 1971; Wicker et al., 1983).

4.1.1.4 Situation 4. *Guilt* from *misbehave* arises when one behaves improperly, violating social norms or personal values. It results from awareness of wrongful actions, causing remorse and self-blame. Bybee (1998) highlighted that males are more likely to feel guilt and shame about aggressive behaviours in the presence of strangers and females are more likely to feel guilt about insensitive behaviour or harsh behaviours. Further, parents likewise are less tolerant of misbehaviour among females than males and are more likely to use discipline

techniques with daughters that lead to guilt. Females compared to males are more willing to concede responsibility for misdeeds and apparently have more difficulty expelling feelings of guilt as evidenced by their higher scores on chronic guilt. Chronic feelings of guilt became a source of self-degradation and precipitating factor in the development of depression and eating disorders. Further, misbehavior can indeed lead to feelings of shame among individuals. When someone engages in actions that are socially unacceptable, inappropriate, or go against commonly held values or norms, it can result in a sense of guilt, embarrassment, or shame. This feeling may arise due to the individual recognizing that their behavior has negatively impacted themselves or others. Therefore, committing a serious transgression resulted in public condemnation, legal repercussions, social stigma, and overwhelming personal regret and remorse (Liyanage & Usoof-Thowfeek, 2023). It emerges when one recognizing the harm caused to others or violating one's own values. This emotional response can prompt apologies, corrective actions, and a commitment to behave more responsibly and considerately in the future.

4.1.1.5 Situation 5. *Guilt from labelling* arises when one unfairly categorizes or judges others based on stereotypes or biases. It results from recognizing the harm caused by these preconceived notions. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a commitment to challenge stereotypes, promote understanding, and treat individuals with fairness and respect. The study of Rocheleau et al. (2015) revealed that being labelled deviant produces detrimental consequences on an individual's self-identity, educational attainment, and employment outcomes (Bernburg et al., 2006; Davies et al., 2003; Western, 2002), and weakens ties to pro-social peer groups (Adams et al., 1996; Bernburg et al., 2006). Further, *shame* in labelling retires from assigning stigmatizing or negative tags to individuals or groups. It stems from a realization of perpetuating stereotypes and discrimination. Byrne (1997) suggests that awareness of stigma creates a sense of shame and difference within individuals. Similarly, Scheff (1998) asserts that when an individual is given a label, such as "mentally ill," the reactions of others and the person's self-perceptions are changed forever. For example, the identity "schizophrenic" becomes an overriding status. If the individual accepts the label, they begin to internalize the attributes (stigma) associated with it. Similarly, Dijker and Koomen (1999) describe stigmatization as a form of social

control that aims to exclude the person from society, and which does not distinguish between the person and his or her behaviour or temporary condition.

4.1.1.6 Situation 6. For *accident* the *guilt* induces when one unintentionally causes harm or damage. It stems from recognizing the unintended consequences of their actions. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a sense of responsibility to address and, if possible, rectify the situation, as well as take steps to prevent future accidents. The study of Haag et al. (2015) revealed that guilt was found to be a significant predictor of Acute Stress Disorder (ASD) severity. Further, Guilt is a negative appraisal has detrimental effects upon posttraumatic adjustment (Foa et al., 1999). Further, both cross-sectional and longitudinal studies involving trauma samples have consistently revealed the negative effect of guilt on posttraumatic stress symptoms (PTSS) (Kletter et al., 2009; Melville et al., 2014; Punamäki et al., 2014; Stotz et al., 2015). Based on these findings of research, guilt specifically, self-blame for a traumatic event now is listed as a symptom of PTSD in DSM-5 (Badour et al., 2017). Further, the *remorse* in an accident appears when one realizes their actions led to unintended harm or damage. They feel genuine regret and guilt for their role in the incident. This emotional response can prompt taking responsibility, offering assistance, and taking precautions to prevent future accidents, fostering accountability and care.

4.1.1.7 Situation 7. *Guilt* from *procrastination* elicits when one delays tasks or responsibilities, leading to a sense of neglect or inefficiency. It stems from recognizing the impact of delayed actions on oneself or others. This guilt prompts feelings of remorse and a determination to manage time better and fulfill obligations promptly. The study of Martincekova and Enright (2020) suggests that procrastination is likely to give rise to guilt because putting things off and delaying tasks usually leads to feelings of guilt afterward. When the person avoid doing something that they know should be doing, like finishing a project or studying for an exam, it often makes the person feel bad and remorse later on. The sense of guilt arises because the person is aware that he didn't use their time well or didn't fulfill responsibilities. So, procrastination tends to bring guilt and *remorse* feelings afterwards and remorse arises from delayed action leading to missed opportunities or unmet responsibilities. As time passes, one realizes the negative consequences, causing a sense of guilt and

regret. This emotional response can motivate change, prompting individuals to address tasks promptly and avoid future procrastination.

4.1.1.8 Situation 8. *Guilt and shame related to criticism* evokes when one feels responsible for hurting or demeaning others through negative feedback. It emerges from the awareness of potentially damaging words or actions. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a sense of responsibility to provide constructive, respectful feedback in the future (Gilbert, 2003). Reid (2010) has found shame to be the best predictor of compulsive sexual behaviour (CSB) and problematic pornography use (PPU) compared to other negative feelings such as sadness or anger. Correspondingly, the study of Cavaglioni (2008) as well as King (2003) have found wrong usage of internet (pornography users) to have a sense of guilt and shame and the tendency to blame themselves which is the actual content of self-criticism. Further, the shame in criticism links to perceiving negative feedback as a reflection of one's worth. It arises when comments are internalized as personal flaws. This self-judgment leads to a feeling of inadequacy and a desire for acceptance, influencing one's self-esteem and response to constructive feedback. Clinical psychologists and counselors mostly use compassionate mind training (CMT) for people with high shame and self-criticism, whose problems tend to be chronic, and who find self-warmth and self-acceptance difficult and frightening. Because studies showed significant reductions in depression, anxiety, self-criticism, shame, inferiority and submissive behaviour while using CMT. Compassion mind training in criticism happens when the critic acknowledges the potential hurt caused by their words. They feel *remorse* for any harshness or insensitivity. This emotional response can lead to offering a sincere apology, seeking to understand the other person's perspective, and delivering feedback more constructively in the future, fostering healthier communication.

4.1.1.9 Situation 9. *Guilt and shame related to the body* can stem from body image issues or perceived physical inadequacies. It arises when one feels dissatisfied or ashamed of their appearance, possibly due to societal pressures or personal standards. This guilt can lead to negative self-perception and a desire for change or acceptance. Preliminary analyses showed women reported significantly more body checking weight and body related shame and guilt than men. Studies like Solomon & Sabiston (2017) evidence the association between body surveillance and body shame.

Body surveillance encompasses affective and cognitive elements (e.g., “During the day, I think about how I look many times” and “I often worry about whether the clothes I am wearing make me look good”; McKinley & Hyde, 1996), body checking is strictly behavioural (e.g., “I pinch my stomach to measure fatness”; Reas et al., 2002). Specifically, body checking encompasses a broad range of behaviours aimed at monitoring one’s weight and overall appearance (Reas et al., 2002). Body checking has been associated with negative body related outcomes among both men and women including body dissatisfaction (Grippio & Hill, 2008), eating pathology and eating disorders (Reas et al., 2006), and shape concerns including muscle dysmorphia (Walker et al., 2009). Body checking has also intensified the relationship between body dissatisfaction and eating pathology among men (Dakanalis et al., 2015) and women (Reas et al., 2002). The study of Solomon-Krakus & Sabiston (2017) found the positive association between body checking and weight with shame and guilt for men and women. Generally, women reported more body checking and negative self-conscious emotions shame and guilt as compared to men. Similarly, Markham et al. (2005) reveals that body image esteem, global self-worth and appearance comparison were collectively a strong predictor of body shame in female university students. Further, the findings of Bessenoff and Snow (2006) shows the cultural norms regarding body image were predictive of body shame in female college students and the shame related to the body also arises from societal standards and self-comparison. It manifests when one perceives their appearance or physical attributes as inadequate or flawed. External judgments and internalized beliefs contribute, leading to a painful sense of inadequacy and a desire to hide or alter one's appearance. This applies to evaluations and judgment about one’s body and physical appearance. Various bodily attributes such as size and shape, texture (e.g. as in acne, facial scarring) and bodily functions can be a source of shame (Lazare, 1987). Because the physical appearance (attractiveness) is one of the first points of social contact and body shame can have serious effects on social behaviour and social confidence. Therefore, nowadays fashion and physical fitness is considered an active hobby to shape the body appearances (Buss, 1994) and studies found that an extreme form of body shame is body dysmorphic disorder.

4.1.1.10 Situation 10. *Guilt in addiction* arises from a sense of wrongdoing related to substance abuse or compulsive behaviours. It results from recognizing the

harm caused to oneself and others. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a desire for recovery, seeking help, and making amends for past actions. Researchers reviled that people with substance dependency often report feelings of guilt. The study of Snoek et al. (2021) suggests that guilt may help overcome addictive behaviour because proneness to guilt is protective (Dearing et al., 2005; Treeby et al., 2018). Further, the drug addiction leads to consequences not only for the individual but also for those closest to them i.e., family members of a person with drug addiction often experience negative consequences on family relationships, social life, and mental health (Orford et al., 2010; Richert et al., 2018). The effects on the family can be understood through the concept of family burden. These emotional stressors are often expressed in worry, anxiety, shame, and guilt (Sales, 2003). A heavy family burden usually affects many aspects of family member's life, including social relations, health, working life and economy (Richert et al., 2018). Further, researchers revealed that family members of individual's drug addiction often experienced prejudice and discrimination on the basis that they could be associated with someone marked by a stigma (Flensburg et al., 2023). The stigma that comes with a drug addiction similarly affects not only the individual but also their parents or family (Corrigan et al., 2006; Jackson et al., 2007; McCann & Lubman, 2018) and elicits the emotion of remorse too. *Remorse* ascends when individuals confront the consequences of their actions, such as damaged relationships or health issues. They feel remorse and guilt for their behaviour, recognizing the negative impact on themselves and others. However, this emotional response can be a catalyst for seeking help, treatment, and recovery.

4.1.1.11 Situation 11. *Guilt* from an *argument* centers when one believes they've contributed to conflict or hurt someone's feelings. It stems from recognizing the impact of words or actions on the relationship. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a sense of responsibility to communicate better and mend any emotional wounds caused. Guilt-prone people are likely to feel guilty in a specific conflict situation, and the emotion of guilt represents a problem that can be addressed and solved by appreciating the other person's perspective (Leith & Baumeister; 1998). *Remorse* in an argument surfaces when individuals realize the hurtful words or actions they employed. They feel regret and guilt for their role in escalating tensions. This emotional response prompts reflection, apology, and a desire for reconciliation, fostering healthier communication and resolution in future conflicts.

4.1.1.12 Situation 12. *Apologizing* related to guilt emerges from acknowledging one's wrongdoing or hurtful actions. It arises from a sense of remorse and a desire to make amends. This guilt prompts the recognition of one's responsibility, leading to a sincere and heartfelt apology, along with a commitment to change behaviour and prevent future harm. The study of Howell et al. (2012) revealed that greater guilt was associated with greater generalized willingness to apologize, greater endorsement of the importance of apology in relation to a hypothetical transgression situations and greater inclusion of important elements of an apology in a written response to the situations. Significantly, Tangney et al. (2009) identify apology as one form of reparation that is fostered by feelings of guilt, but not by feelings of shame. Because apology is an approach-oriented and other-oriented response to a particular transgression incident that may mitigate the consequences of the transgression, it is the type of behavioural response that is fostered by guilt. Similarly, Sandage et al. (2000) people who are generally being willing to apologize are prone to experiences of guilt and remorse. *Remorse* recognizes one's wrongdoing and its impact on others. It involves feeling genuine regret and a sincere desire to make amends. This emotional response drives individuals to take responsibility, express regret, and seek forgiveness, fostering healing and rebuilding trust in relationships.

4.1.1.13 Situation 13. *Shame* in *misfortune* originated from societal expectations and self-perception. When one falls short of perceived norms or experiences adversity, a sense of inadequacy and unworthiness emerges. External judgments and internalized beliefs contribute painful feeling of disgrace and a desire to hide or withdraw. This internal conflict leads to a sense of *remorse* and a desire for atonement, motivating efforts to repair relationships and promote healing. The findings of Tangney et al. (2003) signifies that the shame-proneness was consistently correlated with anger arousal, suspiciousness, resentment, irritability, a tendency to blame others for negative events, and indirect expressions of hostility. Further, the findings from the body of research reviewed by Tangney (1992) include evidence for an inverse relationship between shame and empathy and a link between shame and anger.

4.1.1.14 Situation 14. For *ignoring* the *shame* emotions ascends from neglecting someone's needs or feelings. It emerges when one acknowledges the pain

caused by indifference. This self-awareness prompts a sense of moral dissonance and a desire for empathy and attentiveness, encouraging efforts to acknowledge and address the needs of others.

4.1.1.15 Situation 15. Further, the *shame* in making a *mistake* elicits from realizing an error in judgment or action. It stems from a sense of personal accountability for the misstep. This self-awareness leads to a feeling of inadequacy and a desire for rectification, influencing one's perception of competence and self-worth. The study of Robertson and Long (2018) physicians and other providers may feel a variety of adverse emotions after medical error, including guilt, shame, anxiety, fear, and depression. It is thought that the pervasive culture of perfectionism and individual blame in medicine plays a considerable role toward these negative effects. Therefore, the shame is the emotion that deals with our notion of self. It arises when we make mistakes that reveal some negative aspect when we perform poorly, fail to meet our own or others' expectations, or behave role inappropriately (Keltner, 1996)

4.1.1.16 Situation 16. *Shame in irresponsibility* elicits from neglecting duties or commitments. It emerges when one recognizes the consequences of their actions. This self-awareness leads to a sense of moral failing and a desire for accountability, motivating efforts to fulfill obligations and regain trust from oneself and others. The findings of Tsang (2020) shows that irresponsibility can be characterized as a general unwillingness to take on responsibilities. Characteristics of irresponsibility are often reflected in an antisocial lifestyle, in which individuals consistently fail to meet familial work, financial obligations, and are unable or unwilling to follow through with promises and agreements. This attitude may manifest in various aspects of life, such as financial situations, work behaviour, and relationships with family, friends, and business associates.

4.1.1.17 Situation 17. *Remorse in trust* occurs when one realizes they've betrayed confidence or faith placed in them. They feel deep regret and guilt for their actions. This emotional response can lead to sincere apologies, transparent communication, and consistent reliability in the future, rebuilding trust and strengthening relationships. The study of Pompe et al. (2022) showed that apology with remorse in most cases rebuilt trust the strongest. Further, remorse appeared to lie beyond suspicion I.e.; those low in dispositional trust were more positively influenced by embodied remorse than those high in dispositional trust (Hornsey et al., 2020).

Thus, showing remorse is a skill that every individual must develop. It allows individuals to move on and grow; it can repair relationships that have been long thought to be dead.

4.1.1.18 Situation 18. *Remorse in forgiveness* arises when one deeply regrets past wrongs. They acknowledge their mistakes and genuinely seek absolution. This emotional response prompts sincere apologies, amended behaviour, and a commitment to growth, allowing for healing and the restoration of trust in relationships, fostering reconciliation and mutual understanding. The results of the study Davis and Gold (2011) suggest that increases in perceived remorse decreased attributions and increased empathy and forgiveness. Remorse usually indicates that there are psychological pain and suffering on the part of the wrongdoer. An individual wishes to go back in time and undo the bad deed. Many people regret past misdeeds and think of them often but may, however, never apologize to their victims. Remorse without an apology may mean that both the victim and the offender suffer an entire life; there is no opportunity for healing. Further, Smedes and Lewis (1996) provides guidance for those who wish to better understand forgiveness and learn how to get the strength to forgive those who have caused them hurt and humiliation. Similarly, Worthington et al. (2005) forgiveness can help physical and mental health as it is a major factor in repairing relationships that have been impaired (Worthington and DiBasio, 1990). The alternative to forgiveness is fear, hostility, and thoughts of getting even (Berry et al., 2005).

4.1.2 Situations Evoke Guilt, Shame and Remorse Altogether

4.1.2.1 Situation 1. The social emotions guilt and shame from *performance* stems a sense of not meeting expectations. It arises when one believes they've fallen short of standards, causing feelings of self-blame, guilt and sorrow (Calvalera & Pepe; 2014). The shame in performance shoots from fear of judgment and failure. It evokes when one believes they haven't met expected standards, leading to a sense of unworthiness and embarrassment. Wrong evaluation, comparison to others, and internalized pressure can intensify the feelings of guilt and shame and also impacting the confidence and future endeavours of a person. The study by Thompson et al. (2004) supported that individuals who are highly prone to feeling shame tend to interpret negative outcomes as a result of their own internal characteristics or personal flaws. Instead of attributing these negative events to external circumstances or

specific situations, these individuals internalize the blame, seeing themselves as fundamentally flawed or inadequate. Similarly, the *remorse* in performance surfaces when one recognizes inadequate output. They feel regret for not meeting their own or others' expectations. This emotional response can be a catalyst for self-improvement, driving individuals to refine their skills, seek feedback, and strive for excellence in future endeavours.

4.1.2.2 Situation 2. Similarly, the Guilt and shame from *sin* ascends when a person believes they've violated their moral and religious principles. It stems from a sense of wrongdoing and can lead to feelings of remorse and self-blame. This guilt often prompts individuals to seek forgiveness and make amends for their transgressions. The study of Murray et al. (2007) shows that the more one felt disconnected from God and had spiritual struggles, the more shame and guilt one experienced. Further, the shame in sin emerges from a moral transgression against one's beliefs or societal norms. It arises from a sense of guilt and a feeling of moral failure. This internal conflict leads to a profound sense of unworthiness and a desire for redemption or forgiveness. Mostly in religious domains when the person violates the rules and norms of their own religious he felt sin *for instance.*, in Islam the doing of sexual practice before marriage is prohibited and individual fall in sin. In this way, Islamic practice and spirituality was negatively correlated with sexual permissiveness or any other unlawful activity that is prohibited in religious practices like drinking alcohol, taking adulteries and so on. Therefore, the person who made certain transgression or sin become remorseful and wants to forgive for his act. In this way the remorse in sin arises from recognizing a moral transgression against one's beliefs or values. It involves feeling deep regret and guilt for the wrongful act. This emotional response can lead to seeking forgiveness, repentance, and a commitment to align behaviour with one's ethical principles, fostering personal growth and spiritual reconciliation.

4.1.2.3 Situation 3. Guilt induces from *cheating* when one deliberately deceives, gains an unfair advantage, or breaks established norms. This conscious violation of ethics or rules triggers a sense of wrongdoing, leading to self-reproach and remorse. Guilt often motivates reflection, amends-making, and a commitment to ethical behaviour in the future. The empirical study of Corcoran and Rotter (1987) reported the positive relationship between guilt and cheating behaviour. Researchers

revealed that subjects who felt the most post-transgression guilt are cheated more frequently. Similarly, the shame in cheating arises from violating trust and ethical boundaries. It results from a moral conflict between personal values and deceitful actions. The knowledge of betrayal, coupled with guilt, induces a profound sense of wrongdoing and unworthiness, impacting relationships and self-image. On academic cheating the findings of Singh (2014) suggests that academic institutions should consider four aspects, i.e., direction, competence, opportunity and motivation to enhance the performance of scholars and reduce the plagiarism. On the other hand, public shaming is one of the reprimands for plagiarism, which could be as severe as a dismissal in extreme cases. Hence, it's revealed that emotion of shame could be induced in scholars to reduce plagiarism. Further, the *remorse* in cheating rises from recognizing the breach of trust and emotional harm inflicted on the deceived party. The cheater feels profound regret and guilt for their actions. This emotional response can lead to confessing, seeking forgiveness and a commitment to fidelity, fostering healing and rebuilding trust.

4.1.2.4 Situation 4. Guilt from *lying* stems from knowingly deceives others, breaching trust and integrity. It emerges when one recognizes the dishonesty and its potential harm. This guilt prompts feelings of remorse and a responsibility to come clean, rebuild trust, and uphold honesty in future interactions. Further, remorse appears when the deceiver acknowledges the breach of trust and potential harm caused. They feel guilt and regret for their dishonesty. This emotional response can lead to confessing, seeking forgiveness and a commitment to honesty, mending relationships and rebuilding trust with others. Research revealed that the individuals experience guilt if they are perceived by others as dishonest, even when they have only one anonymous interaction. Therefore, guilt is based on the desire to avoid taking actions that let down another person's expectations about payoffs. The study of Elaad and Sommerfeld (2016) shows the respiration responses significantly differentiated between guilty and innocent participants. The guilty participants rated high their lie telling ability showed larger electro dermal responses to critical items. Similarly, shame in lying appears from the conscious act of deception. It arises when one recognizes the breach of trust and integrity. This internal conflict leads to a sense of moral failing and a desire for redemption, often prompting honesty and a

commitment to rebuilding trust. Feelings of guilt and shame did not differ based on type of deception.

4.1.2.5 Situation 5. Guilt from *separate* happens when one chooses to create distance or end a relationship, causing emotional distress. It arises from recognizing the pain inflicted by the act of parting ways. This guilt triggers remorse and a sense of responsibility for the emotional well-being of the person left behind. In separation the remorse occurs when individuals recognize the emotional toll and pain caused by the distance or ending of a relationship. They feel deep regret for any contributions to the situation. This emotional response can lead to reflection, apology, and efforts to mend or find closure, promoting healing and growth. The Research of Connor et al. (1997) emphasis that guilt and shame related to substance use among college students related to interpersonal guilt and family separation issues, and this relationship may vary across substances. Similarly, the shame in separation initiates from the act of isolating or excluding others. It arises from recognizing the pain caused by exclusion. This awareness leads to a sense of moral discord and a desire for inclusion and understanding, prompting efforts to bridge divides and fosters a sense of belonging. Further, the emotions of shame and guilt had a significant relationship in the association between parental bonding (maternal and paternal) and suicidal ideation. In this way, the shame and guilt have been reported to play central roles for individuals who separate and commit suicide.

4.1.2.6 Situation 6. Guilt from *failure* happens when one feels personally responsible for falling short of expectations or goals. It stems from a sense of letting oneself down. This guilt can be harsh, but it prompts reflection, a desire for self-improvement, and a determination to do better in the future. The study of Stoeber et al. (2008) related to the perfectionism that differentiate between adaptive and maladaptive aspects the findings show that individuals who strive for perfection experience more pride after success whereas shame and guilt strive after failure. Despite the importance of being able to learn from our mistakes, but the failure of any kind are create distress. The distress created by recognition of moral failure often prompts responses of anger, avoidance, and defensiveness. Similarly the evocation of shame in failure arises from a sense of falling short of expectations. It stems from a perceived inadequacy in achieving desired outcomes. This self-judgment leads to a feeling of unworthiness and a desire for redemption, influencing one's self-esteem and

future efforts. Failures of all kinds (e.g. in passing exams) and not reaching certain standards or achievements can be a source of shame. And as with other sources of shame social comparison plays a salient role (Gilbert et al; 1995). If everyone fails an exam this is probably less shaming than if you are the only one. As many theorists have pointed out some children grow up in an atmosphere where they only feel accepted and lovable if they demonstrate abilities to achieve certain standards and goals (Gilbert, 1992). Failure brings intense feelings of shame and loss of social attractiveness and social attention holding power from potential admiring and loving others.

4.1.2.7 Situation 7. Guilt and shame from *stealing* arises when one knowingly takes something that doesn't belong to them. It stems from the awareness of wrongful actions and the infringement on others' rights. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a responsibility to make amends by returning the stolen item or seeking forgiveness from the victim. The study of Giner-Sorolla & McGee (2020) showed that stealing decreases significantly when shaming is introduced publically. Further, it's observed the subjects who are more aroused are more likely to steal in the first condition and also more likely to stop stealing in the second condition.

4.1.2.8 Situation 8. Guilt and shame from *disobedience* happens when one knowingly disobeys rules. It stems from recognizing the breach of trust or expectations. This guilt triggers feelings of remorse and a sense of responsibility to adhere to established guidelines, rebuild trust, and strive for better compliance in the future. In disobedience, the remorse arises when one realizes they've defied authority or values and feel regret and guilt for their actions. This emotional response can prompt reflection, acknowledgment of wrongdoing, and a commitment to follow rules and principles in the future, mending relationships and fostering personal growth. Similarly, shame in disobedience arises from defying rules or authority figures. Further, Thomason (2015) reveals that shame is a painful emotion concerned with the failure to live up to certain standards, norms, and ideals. Therefore, it stems from acknowledging the breach of trust or societal norms. This self-awareness leads to a feeling of moral conflict and a desire for reconciliation, prompting efforts to amend behaviour and rebuild trust with those affected. The study of Savensson et al. (2013) show that the relationship between parental monitoring, deviant peers, moral values

and offending is substantially related to shame and guilt. This study clearly suggests that both shame and guilt need to be included in the explanation of wrong.

4.1.2.9 Situation 9. Guilt and remorse from *damage* emerges when one feels responsible for another's misfortune and it ascends sense of shame and self-blame for not preventing the loss. Remorse recognizing the harm inflicted on people or property. The individual feels shame and guilt for their actions. This emotional response can lead to taking responsibility, offering reparations, and implementing preventative measures. Further, this guilt can be irrational, but it triggers profound feelings of remorse and a longing to somehow alleviate the pain of loss. Feelings of guilt and shame of loss of control were predominant in women with recurrent pregnancy loss (RPL). Women with primary RPL compared to secondary RPL more often felt less self-confident and that life wasn't worth living (Solt et al; 2022).

4.1.3 Aim 2

Consequently, in aim 2 we evaluate the emotional experiences of guilt, shame and remorse with the levels of appraisal. In *guilt* the chi-square test of independence displays the significant independence of the levels of appraisal and the four domains (occurrence, duration, reoccurrence and intensity) of subjective feeling state of guilt. The study findings show distinct patterns in adult's guilt experience and its independence with levels of appraisal over various frames. The findings are supported by the Roseman (1991) that appraisal had a significant independence upon emotions and predicts the relative intensities of emotions across a wide variety of situations. Within the initial six to twelve months, guilt tends to associate more *frequently* with moderate levels of appraisal rather than low or high levels. However, guilt experienced after a year leans towards higher levels of appraisal, followed by low and medium levels. In context of *duration* guilt periods (measured in days) exhibit a higher occurrence of low and moderate levels of appraisal, while prolonged guilt over months or years is associated more frequently with medium and high levels of appraisal. Similarly, the guilt *reoccurrence* within early days and months tends towards moderate and high levels of appraisal, whereas guilt recurrence after a few years shows a higher frequency at the low level, followed by medium and high levels. Notably, when guilt *intensity* is moderate in the early stages, it often aligns with more frequent low and medium levels of appraisal rather than high levels. Situations with moderately and very high guilt intensity more commonly demonstrate medium and

high levels of appraisal. Further Multivariate analysis in guilt shed light on findings that the high level of appraisal exhibited greater emotional experience of bodily symptoms, expressive reactions, verbal reactions and psychological consequences as compared to moderate and low appraisal levels. The study is supported by Pivetti et al. (2016) that shame, guilt, and anger elicits different psychological, physical, and behavioural patterns and these reactive systems influence the social adjustment of young adults. Because the appraisal triggers bodily tension, frowns, or closed-off gestures, along with verbal expressions of distress or pessimism and psychologically lead to heightened anxiety, reduced self-esteem, and a sense of overwhelm (Baumeister et al. 1994). Further, the experience of guilt involves various levels of appraisal that can manifest in physiological, behavioural, and verbal changes. Initially, at the physiological level, guilt is associated with increased activation in specific brain regions, such as the anterior insula and the anterior cingulate cortex. Studies using neuroimaging techniques such as functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) have highlighted these areas' involvement in processing feelings of guilt. The study of Wagner et al. (2011) found heightened activity in the anterior insula when participants experienced guilt during a moral decision-making task. This increased brain activity indicates the physiological underpinnings of guilt and suggesting a neural basis for this emotional experience. At a low level of appraisal, physiological changes manifest subtly, such as increased heart rate, perspiration, or mild discomfort and behavioural cues at this level could involve avoiding eye contact, fidgeting, or displaying signs of nervousness. Further, the research of Dickerson et al. (2004) highlighted that increased guilt appraisal amplify cortisol levels, indicating heightened stress. In this way, the individual behaviour exhibit more noticeable signs of distress, such as pacing, restlessness and withdrawing from social interaction. Further, as the person realizes the event very sharply and feel guilty himself/herself. The verbal expressions could evolve into genuine apologies and increased self-criticism, reflecting a deeper recognition of personal responsibility and remorse. This escalation in responses aligns with the concept that higher levels of guilt appraisal correspond to a more significant emotional impact and engagement with the moral transgression.

Similarly *in shame* the chi-square test of independence displays the significant association of the levels of appraisal and the four (occurrence, duration, reoccurrence

and intensity) domains of subjective feeling state of shame. The study findings revealed distinct trends in adults perceive and assess shame across various timeframes and levels of appraisal. Specifically, adults experiencing shame within the initial six to twelve months often reported a higher frequency of moderate appraisal levels in comparison to both lower and higher levels of appraisal. Moreover, shorter *durations* of shame, lasting only a few days tended to be associated more frequently with lower to medium levels of appraisal, while longer-lasting shame experiences spanning months or years were more commonly linked to medium to high appraisal levels. Furthermore, the *recurrence* of shame shortly after its initial occurrence, whether within days or months, exhibited a heightened frequency of moderate to high appraisal levels. In contrast, shame reoccurrence after a few years was more regularly connected with a low level of appraisal followed by medium to high levels. Importantly, the *intensity* of shame experiences also influenced their appraisal i.e.; situations with somewhat lower intensity shame were typically associated with low to medium levels of appraisal, whereas moderately and very high intensity shame scenarios were more often linked to medium to high levels of appraisal. Further, Multivariate analysis in shame shed light on findings that the high level of appraisal exhibited high level emotional experience of bodily symptoms, expressive reactions, verbal reactions and psychological consequences as compared to moderate and low appraisal levels. Because the evidence lends support to the idea that shame operates as a moral emotion and individuals physiological and behaviours changes are happen when shameful event occur (Smith et al., 2002). Further, the physiological changes associated with low levels of shame appraisal include a slight increase in heart rate and skin conductance and indicative of a mild stress response. Tangney and Dearing (2002) revealed that at low levels of shame individuals display subtle non-verbal cues such as lowered gaze, slumped posture, or fidgeting, reflecting a discomfort or unease with the situation. Similarly, the behavioural changes manifest withdrawal or a desire to hide, seeking to avoid further exposure or judgment. However, as the level of shame appraisal intensifies, physiological responses may become more pronounced, with heightened activation of the sympathetic nervous system leading to increased heart rate, sweating, and even blushing. Because the physiological responses potentially leading to a state of extreme distress and individual with shame exhibit physiological symptoms akin to a panic attack, including rapid breathing, trembling, or a sense of dissociation (Gilbert, 1998). Further, the study of Tracy and Robins

(2008) support the present study that shame prompt more noticeable non-verbal behavior's such as covering one's face, turning away, or attempting to physically shrink in size. This thing is also seen in verbal changes that include avoiding eye contact, speaking softly, or displaying a hesitant speech pattern, reflecting the individual's attempt to conceal or downplay their perceived inadequacy or failure. Similarly, the psychological and behavioural manifestations are involving complete withdrawal, hiding, anxiety (Muris et al., 2014) and depression (Tangney & Dearing, 2002; Kim et al., 2011) and even self-harming or suicide tendencies.

Similarly, in *remorse* the chi-square test of independence highlights a significant association between levels of appraisal and the four domains of subjective feeling state of guilt: occurrence, duration, reoccurrence, and intensity. The study findings unveil distinct trends in how adults perceive and experience remorse across different frames. Adults undergoing remorse within the initial six to twelve months tend to more frequently appraise it at a moderate level compared to lower or higher levels of appraisal. Furthermore, remorse experienced over shorter durations, measured in days, tends to manifest more frequently at lower and medium appraisal levels, while extended periods of remorse spanning months or years align more often with medium and high levels of appraisal. Additionally, the reappearance of remorse within shorter intervals, such as days or months, is associated with higher frequencies at moderate and high appraisal levels, whereas longer intervals, like years, exhibit a higher occurrence at the lower level of appraisal. The intensity of remorse also influences its appraisal, with somewhat intense remorse occurrences more prevalent at lower and medium appraisal levels, while moderately and very highly intense remorse situations show a higher frequency at medium and high appraisal levels. Further Multivariate analysis in remorse shed light on findings the high level of appraisal exhibited high level experience of bodily symptoms, expressive reactions, verbal reactions and psychological consequences as compared to moderate and low appraisal levels. Because, remorse is complex emotion experience characterized by feelings of guilt, regret, and a desire for atonement following a wrongdoing.

The study of Kiehl et al. (2006) using functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI) found that feelings of remorse are associated with increased activation in brain regions linked to emotional processing, such as the anterior insula, amygdala and prefrontal cortex. These regions are involved in regulating emotions and decision-

making, demonstrating the physiological changes that occur during the experience of remorse. Moreover, studies on the autonomic nervous system responses to guilt and remorse, such as the work by Tangney et al. (2007), have shown that individuals experiencing remorse may exhibit increased heart rate, perspiration, and other physiological indicators of stress, reflecting the body's response to the emotional weight of remorse. Similarly the psychological aspect of the remorse involves a profound sense of moral self-assessment and cognitive reflection. Because the experience of remorse involves a cognitive appraisal of one's actions, leading to self-reproach and an internal evaluation of moral standards (Baumeister et al., 1994). This introspective process can lead to increased rumination and self-blame, impacting one's psychological well-being. Moreover, remorse often involves feelings of empathy and a desire to repair the harm caused, and the person motivates for seeking forgiveness and making amends (McCullough et al., 1997). As the level of remorse intensifies, individuals may display changes in expressive behaviour, such as increased displays of sadness, regret, or attempts to communicate their feelings of remorse through non-verbal cues.

In collective *cultures* the perception and manifestation of guilt are significantly influenced by deeply ingrained societal norms and cultural values. Family and community bonds are pivotal to experience the emotions of guilt, as individuals often prioritize collective well-being over personal emotions. Guilt is frequently intertwined and affects the harmonious relationships and honor of the family or community. Actions that deviate from societal expectations or disrupt social harmony evoke a sense of guilt due to the interconnectedness of individuals within these collective structures. In this way, the people of Kashmir residing in the region of South Asia have a rich cultural heritage that greatly values group harmony and social cohesion. They strongly emphasis on community, mutual respect, and collective well-being. Likewise, the cultural bond of people of Kashmir is deeply rooted in shared traditions, language, and customs, fostering a sense of unity among its people. Further, there is a strong sense of community support and mutual assistance among Kashmiri people too. In Kashmir community the concept of “Milchar” “Baradari” “Chatas” "Hamdardi" is customarily valued, leading individuals to assist each other during times of need, whether it's in the form of financial help, emotional support, and societal celebrations. Additionally, the emphasis on respecting authority figures,

adherence to hierarchical structures, and the sense of collective responsibility (May & Hoffman, 1991; Hoffman, 2014) contribute to the experience of guilt in situations where these societal norms are violated . Expressions of guilt are often indirect, involving non-verbal cues or actions to rectify the perceived wrongdoing, aligning with the collective culture's inclination towards maintaining social harmony.

Festinger (1957) cognitive system is defined as a complex, interacting set of beliefs, attitudes, and values that affect and are affected by behaviour (Yahya & Sukmayadi, 2020) and people tend to seek consistency among their cognitions, such as beliefs and opinions. However, when there is some dissonance with their cognitive beliefs it affects the human physical and psychological behaviour. Consequently, some of the emotions that we experience resulting from cognitive dissonance are anger, guilt, frustration, anxiety, stress, and other psychosomatic issuers (Fontanari et al., 2012) that further changes the individual physical and expressive behaviour. Therefore, in collective cultures guilt is intricately tied to expectations, relationships, moral values, and the maintenance of social cohesion. Conversely, shifting of collective culture to individualistic culture experiences the emotions of guilt. The transformation of Uttar Pradesh's collective culture into individual culture is a multifaceted process influenced by several interconnected factors. Urbanization and stitching of communities due to migration contribute to a shift towards more individualistic lifestyles, characterized by a focus on personal goals and aspirations challenging to follow traditional norms and values experiences the person guilt. It's important to recognize that this transition is not uniform and varies across communities and regions within Uttar Pradesh, with elements of collective culture often coexisting with emerging individualistic tendencies.

Research suggests that *both males and females* experience the emotions of guilt, shame, and remorse and find the notable differences in the way these emotions are expressed and processed. The given study highlights no differences in male and female participants in guilt experiences. However, the differences shown in shame and remorse emotions of male and females. The study of Tangney and Fischer (1995) supported that males experience shame more intensely than females, particularly in contexts related to failure or public scrutiny. Similarly, Morrison (2014) reviled that males feel shame in situations involving task failure and bad performance. Because their shame is likely to be linked to failures in instrumental achievement (Efthim &

Mahaik, 2001). Whereas women's shame is more likely to experience shame about physical attractiveness or failure in relationships. Because their cognition are tends to revolve around relational failures. Further, males feel more shame because of masculine norms that is relate to preventions regarding feeling exposed, vulnerable, and out of control (Krugman, 1995). Because men are committed to traditional masculine schemas and want to Defensive maneuvers such as externalization to manage the painful affect (Bogo et al., 1970; Ihilevich & Gleser, 1993).

Similarly, remorse involve a deep sense of guilt or regret for one's actions, appears to be more readily expressed by females (Lapsley & Narvaez; 2004), possibly due to *societal expectations and gender-specific socialization*. Tannenbaum and Howie (2002) findings shows that women habitually internalize cultural norms emphasizing empathy, nurturing, and emotional sensitivity, leading to heightened feelings of remorse when they perceive they have fallen short of these ideals. Moreover, the findings of Eagly and Crowley (1986) shows that women are frequently socialized to prioritize relationships and harmony, which could intensify their emotional responses to situations where they feel they've caused harm or disrupted social bonds. These societal pressures and gendered socialization processes may contribute to the amplified experience of remorse observed in females.

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